



DEPARTMENT OF NATURAL RESOURCES

Colorado Parks and Wildlife

CHAPTER W-12 - LAKE LICENSES

2 CCR 406-12

[Editor's Notes follow the text of the rules at the end of this CCR Document.]

ARTICLE I - GENERAL PROVISIONS

#1200 - DEFINITIONS

- A. **"Commercial Lake License"** issued for the operation of privately owned lakes for purposes of charging customers to fish. No live fish or viable gametes may be sold or transported from the premises.
- B. **"Private Lake License"** issued for the operation of privately owned lakes for the purpose of fishing when no fee is charged; no fish or gametes may be sold or live fish or viable gametes transported from the premises.

#1201 - LICENSE REQUIREMENTS

- A. Except as otherwise provided, no person shall possess, acquire, purchase, or attempt to possess, acquire or purchase, live fish or viable gametes unless he/she first obtains a proper lake license as provided for in this chapter. No person may import, collect, barter, buy, transfer or possess any live aquatic species not listed under #012 of Chapter W-0 regulations, except as otherwise provided.
- B. Except as otherwise provided, no person may take or possess any live fish or viable gametes from the wild. No person may acquire live fish or viable gametes for possession pursuant to a commercial or private lake license unless they are acquired from a person who possesses a valid Colorado aquaculture facility permit issued by the Department of Agriculture or a valid aquatic wildlife importation licensed issued by the Division and they otherwise comply with all other applicable Parks and Wildlife Commission regulations.
- C. Exemptions from License Requirements
 - 1. No lake license, commercial or private, shall be required for persons to obtain and possess live fish for private ponds as long as such ponds are closed systems, not connected physically or temporally to state waters. Only live fish specified in #012 of Chapter W-0 regulations may be held in private ponds and such fish shall not under any circumstances, be released in state waters (Comm. Reg. #013A).
 - 2. No commercial lake license or private lake license shall be required of any Federal, state, county, municipal agency, or any person with a valid scientific collecting permit conducting research and performing educational activities with lawfully acquired fish; or zoos accredited by American Association of Zoological Parks and Aquariums; however, such entities must adhere to all other Division of Parks and Wildlife regulations including record keeping and importation requirements.

- D.** Non-compliance with the provisions of this chapter and general provisions pertaining to lake licenses, commercial or private, may result in revocation of the license pursuant to the provision of 33-6-106. The licensee whose license is revoked shall lawfully dispose of fish and viable gametes held pursuant to the license. Fish and viable gametes must be disposed of by the owner or his agent within 6 months of license revocation.

#1202 - PERMITTED ACTIVITIES

A. Commercial Lake License

- 1.** Licensees of commercial lakes may purchase fish and viable gametes allowed under #012 of Chapter W-0 regulations for the operation of their privately owned lakes for the purpose of charging customers to fish. No live fish or viable gametes may be sold or transported from the premises. A fishing license shall not be required for customers to fish in a commercial lake.

B. Private Lake License

- 1.** Licensees of private lakes may purchase fish or viable gametes allowed under #012 of Chapter W-0 regulations for the operation of their privately owned lakes for the purpose of fishing when no fee is charged. No fish or gametes may be sold or live fish or viable gametes transported from the premises. A fishing license shall not be required to fish in a licensed private lake.

#1203 - APPLICATION AND LICENSING PROCEDURE

- A.** Applicants shall apply for required licenses on forms provided by the Division, accompanied by funds in the amount of the license fee established in 33-4-102 (2) C.R.S. as may be amended.
- B.** Applicants shall list the species of fish they desire to possess.
- C.** A Division employee may make a personal inspection of the applicant's facilities to determine compliance with these regulations.
- D.** A commercial lake license, or private lake license will not be issued for waters which have been stocked with fish at public expense within five (5) years prior to application unless: (a) all fish stocked in such waters have been removed or eliminated: or (b) the applicant has negotiated with the Division for purchase, or salvage of state-stocked fish.
- E.** All licensed lakes shall be equipped with continuously operated screening installations to prevent fish held under a commercial lake or private lake license from entering from or leaving to, connected state waters.
- F.** An application for a license issuance or renewal shall be denied in its entirety or limited as to species authorized to be kept if necessary to protect Colorado's wildlife resources from a significant negative impact.
- 1.** Written notification of denial will be furnished to the applicant stating the reasons for denial within forty-five (45) days of the receipt of a completed application.
- 2.** Review of a denial shall be in accordance with section 24-4-104, C.R.S. (1988 & 1989 Supp.), as may be amended.

G. Expiration and Renewal of Licenses

1. Commercial lake licenses shall expire December thirty-one (31) of each year. Private lake licenses are ten (10) year licenses which shall expire on December thirty-one (31) of the tenth year of the term of the license. The Division will provide license holders renewal information prior to the expiration of an issued license. Commercial and private lake licenses are non-transferable.
2. For a non-transferable lifetime private lake license issued prior to March 2, 2018, the original license shall remain valid contingent upon the licensee meeting all current regulations.
3. An additional fee is not required to amend a license (add more species).

#1204 - INSPECTION

- A.** The licensee must allow the inspection of fish or viable gametes by representatives of the Division or other persons authorized to enforce these regulations at any reasonable time. Records required by these regulations shall be made available to Division employees during regular business hours.

#1205 - RECORD KEEPING

- A.** Acquisition: All lake licensees, commercial and private, shall maintain annual records documenting the acquisition of fish and viable gametes. The records shall show the name and address of the person of whom such fish and viable gametes were obtained, date of acquisition and species, number and size of the fish and viable gametes obtained. All records will be retained for the period of ownership of the fish or viable gametes and for three (3) years after disposition.
- B.** All original records must be kept at the same location as the commercial lake or private lake or at the Colorado address of the licensee.

#1206 – VACANT

#1207 - SPECIAL REGULATIONS

- A.** Most Restrictive Federal or State Law - In all cases of licensing, taking, possession, importation, exportation, release, marking and sale of wildlife, the most restrictive state or federal law shall apply.
- B.** Commercial and private lakes and connecting channels shall not be a part of a natural stream unless constructed and licensed prior to January 1, 1970 or unless specifically authorized by the director of the Division upon his determination that such use would not be detrimental to the natural stream and its resources. Two or more lakes may be operated and maintained under one lake license if such lakes are under the same management.

Editor's Notes

History

Chapter 12 recodified as 2 CCR 406-12 on 04/01/2009; for history and versions prior to 04/01/2009, see 2 CCR 406-8.

Sections 1201-1203 eff. 03/02/2018.